



Required Capstone Project: Module 10

Due Aug 12 by 11:59pm**Points** None**Available** after Aug 5 at 12am

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Learning Outcomes Addressed

- Understand how AI, GenAI and Agentic AI work and where they apply in business.
- Use prompts effectively for analysis, decision-making and content generation.
- Map business workflows and identify where AI can drive automation and efficiency.
- Evaluate AI opportunities using feasibility, ROI and impact criteria.
- Build AI adoption roadmaps aligned to business goals and KPIs.
- Apply data governance, privacy and ethical AI principles.

Phase 4 – Strategy & Industry Context

Milestone 10: Industry Benchmark & Competitive Positioning Note

Estimated Effort: 1.5 Hours

Objective

Artificial Intelligence adoption varies significantly across industries.

Some sectors — such as technology, finance, and digital services — have rapidly adopted **Generative AI and agentic systems** across multiple operational functions.

Other sectors are still experimenting with **pilot projects and early-stage implementations**.

For organisations developing AI strategies, it is important to understand how **industry peers and competitors are adopting AI**.

Studying real-world implementations helps organisations understand:

- how AI solutions are being deployed
- the scale of adoption across organisations
- the outcomes achieved by early adopters
- lessons that can inform future AI initiatives

In this module, you will analyse **real-world examples of AI adoption within your industry** and reflect on how these examples inform your own AI solution developed in the capstone project.

How This Connects to Earlier Modules

In previous modules, you designed an **AI-enabled solution** for a specific business workflow.

You analysed:

- the workflow baseline
- AI-enabled redesign
- agent architecture and governance
- financial and strategic value

In this module, you will step outside your internal design and examine:

How are other organisations in this industry using AI?

This helps you understand whether your solution aligns with **industry trends and competitive practices**

Note: This is a required assignment and counts towards programme completion.

Task Overview

Create an **Industry Benchmark & Competitive Positioning Note** by analysing **two companies within your industry** that are using:

- Generative AI
- AI automation systems
- AI agents or agentic workflows

For each company, you will summarise:

- the AI use case implemented
- the scale of implementation
- the outcomes reported
- lessons relevant to your capstone AI solution

Finally, you will reflect on how your proposed AI solution compares with **industry practices and competitive positioning**.

Selecting the Industry

Your analysis should focus on the **same industry or operational domain** used for your capstone workflow.

For example:

Capstone Workflow	Relevant Industry
Customer support automation	Retail / technology / telecommunications
Invoice processing	Finance / enterprise operations
Marketing content generation	Media / marketing / e-commerce
Supply chain forecasting	Manufacturing / logistics

The goal is to analyse **companies facing similar operational challenges**.

Step 1 — Identify Two Companies Using AI

Identify **two organisations in your industry** that have implemented AI solutions related to operations, customer experience, or decision-making.

Prefer examples that have:

- publicly documented AI initiatives
- reported case studies or industry articles
- measurable outcomes or performance improvements

Sources may include:

- company announcements
- technology vendor case studies
- consulting reports
- industry publications

Example (Illustrative)

Industry: Retail

Company	AI Application
Company A	AI-powered customer support assistant
Company B	AI demand forecasting for supply chain optimisation

Step 2 — Describe the AI Implementation

For each company, briefly describe:

- the **AI use case** implemented
- the **business problem** addressed
- the **type of AI technology used**

Focus on how AI is applied in **real operational contexts**.

Example (Illustrative)

Company A uses Generative AI to automatically respond to customer support enquiries and assist human support agents.

Company B uses machine learning models to predict product demand and optimise inventory management.

Step 3 — Assess Implementation Scale

Implementation scale refers to **how extensively the AI system is used within the organisation.**

Consider factors such as:

- whether the system is a **pilot project or enterprise-wide deployment**
- how many teams or departments use the system
- the number of transactions or processes handled by AI

Example

Company	Implementation Scale
Company A	AI assistant used across global customer support operations
Company B	AI forecasting system used across multiple distribution centres

This helps determine whether AI is **experimental or operationally integrated.**

Step 4 — Identify Reported Outcomes

Where available, identify **reported outcomes** from the AI implementation.

These may include:

- efficiency improvements
- cost reductions
- faster processing times
- improved customer satisfaction
- increased revenue

Example

Company	Reported Outcomes
Company A	Reduced support response time by 40%
Company B	Improved inventory forecasting accuracy

These outcomes demonstrate **the real business impact of AI adoption.**

Step 5 — Identify Lessons for Your AI Solution

Based on the two case examples, identify **lessons relevant to your capstone AI solution**.

Consider questions such as:

- what design choices appear successful?
- what operational challenges were encountered?
- how were AI systems integrated into existing workflows?

These lessons help refine your **own AI design thinking**.

Example (Illustrative)

Lessons for Capstone Solution

- AI systems require integration with existing enterprise platforms
 - human oversight remains important in customer-facing applications
 - successful implementations start with clearly defined workflows
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Step 6 — Reflect on Competitive Positioning

Finally, reflect on how your capstone AI solution compares with **industry practices**.

Consider:

- whether your solution aligns with current industry trends
- whether competitors are already implementing similar AI capabilities
- whether your solution could provide **competitive advantage**

This reflection helps connect **AI design with industry strategy**.

Required Output Structure

Your **Industry Benchmark & Competitive Positioning Note** should include:

1. Company 1 Benchmark

Brief description of the AI implementation, scale, and outcomes.

2. Company 2 Benchmark

Brief description of the AI implementation, scale, and outcomes.

3. Key Insights for Your AI Solution

Lessons drawn from the two industry examples.

4. Competitive Positioning Reflection

Short reflection explaining how your proposed AI solution compares with industry practices.

Practical Tips

Choose Well-Documented Examples

Select companies where AI implementations are **publicly documented** through articles, reports, or case studies.

This makes it easier to identify outcomes and lessons.

Focus on Operational AI Applications

Prioritise examples where AI is used in **real operational workflows**, rather than purely experimental technologies.

Connect Insights to Your Solution

Your analysis should not just describe companies — it should explain **what their experience teaches you about your own AI initiative**.

Avoid These Common Mistakes

- ✗ Selecting companies from unrelated industries
- ✗ Describing AI technologies without explaining the business use case
- ✗ Ignoring implementation outcomes
- ✗ Failing to connect industry insights to your own solution

Effective benchmarking identifies **practical lessons from real implementations.**

Submission

Before submitting your **Industry Benchmark & Competitive Positioning Note**, confirm that you have included:

- ✓ Two industry company benchmarks
- ✓ Description of AI implementation and scale
- ✓ Reported outcomes where available
- ✓ Lessons relevant to your capstone AI solution
- ✓ Reflection on competitive positioning

Instructions:

- Use the same document that you downloaded in Module 1 and include your responses.
- We recommend you add additional text boxes or slides (if needed) for each milestone task to ensure that your responses are documented in a proper format.
- The document will gradually grow as you complete each capstone milestone. The final submission occurs at the end of Module 14.

Grading Rubric

Maximum Points: 15

Criteria	Full Points	0 Points
Company 1 Benchmark (4 points)	The submission clearly describes the AI implementation, business use case, implementation scale, and reported outcomes for the first organisation, demonstrating	The benchmark for the first organisation is missing. (0 points)

Criteria	Full Points	0 Points
	relevance to the selected industry. (4 points)	
Company 2 Benchmark (4 points)	The submission clearly describes the AI implementation, business use case, implementation scale, and reported outcomes for the second organisation, demonstrating relevance to the selected industry. (4 points)	The benchmark for the second organisation is missing. (0 points)
Key Insights for the AI Solution (4 points)	The submission identifies meaningful lessons from both industry benchmarks and clearly explains how these insights strengthen or refine the proposed capstone AI solution. (4 points)	The key insights are missing. (0 points)
Competitive Positioning Reflection (3 points)	The submission reflects on how the proposed AI solution compares with current industry practices and explains its potential competitive positioning or strategic advantage. (3 points)	Reflection on competitive positioning or comparison with current industry practices is missing. (0 points)

Why this Step Matters

AI adoption is increasingly shaping **competitive dynamics across industries**.

Organisations that understand how competitors are using AI can:

- identify emerging best practices
- avoid common implementation mistakes
- refine their own AI strategies

Industry benchmarking helps organisations ensure that their AI initiatives remain **relevant, competitive, and strategically aligned**.

In the next module, you will explore how organisations design **AI governance frameworks to manage risks and ensure responsible deployment at scale**.

